

LEARN, SPEAK, SHINE!



QUESTION OF THE DAY

- ✓ Every student answers one question.
- ✓ Builds confidence and gives equal chance to all.



SENTENCE FORMATION PRACTICE

- ✓ Create your own sentences.
- ✓ Improves grammar + vocabulary



SPEAKING ROUND

- ✓ Share your answers aloud.
- ✓ Boosts fluency & removes hesitation



FEEDBACK & CORRECTIONS

- ✓ Trainer guides on grammar & pronunciation.
- ✓ Encourages progress with positive motivation



English Proficiency Program

INTERACTIVE | PRACTICAL | CONFIDENCE-BUILDING

OCTOBER 30

English Batch 02:30 PM

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Pendown: Keen Learner



Topic of the Day:

1. Simple Past Tense
2. Past Continue Tense/Past progressive



Simple Past Tense

The Simple Past Tense is used to talk about actions or events that happened in the past and are now completed.

Simple past is used:

- **To narrate past events.**
 - Yesterday, I **went** to the market, **met** my old friend, and we **talked** for hours.
 - 👉 All the actions (*went, met, talked*) are **completed past actions**, so we use **simple past**.
- **Making it useful in storytelling**
 - The prince saw a dragon, drew his sword, and fought bravely.
 - 👉 Each verb shows a past action in a story sequence — perfect for narration.
- **Sharing experiences.**
 - I **visited** Goa last year. It **was** a beautiful place, and I **enjoyed** the beaches a lot.
 - 👉 The speaker is **recalling** a past experience.

All verbs — *visited, was, enjoyed* — show **completed actions** in the past.



Formula

- Subject + V2

◆ Regular Verbs

- Formed by adding “-ed” to the base verb.
- Examples:
 - watch → watched,
 - walk → walked,
 - play → played.
- The same past form is used for **all subjects** (I, you, he, she, we, they).
- **Example:**
 - I walked my dog yesterday.
 - She played the guitar at my party last month.
 - The students studied last night.

◆ Irregular Verbs

- **Do not** follow the “-ed” rule.
- They change into a **different form** in the past.
- Examples:
 - do → did
 - drink → drank
 - eat → ate
 - go → went
 - have → had
 - run → ran
- **Example:**
 - I ate breakfast early.
 - They went to the park.
 - He sang beautifully.

◆ Verb “Be” in Simple Past

- Two forms: **was** and **were**.

- Was → I, he, she, it
- Were → you, we, they
- **Examples:**
 - I was cold yesterday afternoon.
 - My dog was hungry.
 - They were happy after the trip.

✓ **Ref Video**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ml3S3kdkofo>

 Past Progressive Tense (Past Continuous Tense)

The Past Progressive Tense describes an action that was happening (in progress) at a particular time in the past.

✓ **Formula**

- Subject + was/were + verb + ing

Subject	Helping Verb	Main Verb	Example
I / He / She / It	was	Verb + ing	She was reading.
You / We / They	were	Verb + ing	They were playing.

Usage (When to Use Past Progressive)

1. To show an action that was happening at a specific time in the past
👉 At 8 PM yesterday, I **was watching** TV.
2. To describe two actions happening at the same time in the past
👉 While I **was studying**, my brother **was playing** games.
3. To describe an interrupted action (one action in progress when another happened)
👉 I **was walking** to school when it **started** raining.
4. To set the scene in a story
👉 The sun **was shining**, and the birds **were singing**.

⚖️ Comparison with Simple Past Tense

- The **Simple Past** shows **completed actions** at a specific time (e.g., *I called my friend at 9 PM*).
- For short, finished actions → use Simple Past (e.g., *I talked to my friend*).
- For actions happening **alongside another**, use Past Progressive (e.g., *I was watching TV when.*).

Aspect	Simple Past 🕒	Past Progressive 🔄
🌱 Form	Verb + ed / 2nd form	was/were + verb + ing
💬 Example	I watched TV.	I was watching TV.
⚡ Action Type	Shows completed past actions	Shows ongoing past actions.
🕒 Time Focus	Specific moment (finished)	Duration / background
✂️ Interrupted Action	Used for the short action (<i>The power went out</i>)	Used for the long action (<i>I was watching TV</i>)
👉 Simultaneous Actions	Not usually used	<i>While I was reading, she was cooking.</i>
📅 Common Time Markers	yesterday, last night, ago, in 2010	while, when, at that time

Aspect	Simple Past 🕒	Past Progressive 🔄
🎯 Usage Summary	Completed events in the past	Ongoing or interrupted past actions

◆ Past Progressive Emphasizes Long Actions

- The **Past Progressive** highlights that an action **continued for some time** in the past.
- Example:
 - Simple Past: *She cooked dinner.* (completed)
 - Past Progressive: *She was cooking dinner.* (ongoing)

◆ Past Progressive and Interrupted Actions

- Used when a **short past action** interrupts a **longer ongoing past action**.
 - 👉 *I **was reading** when the phone **rang**.*
- Also used for **two long past actions** happening **at the same time**.
 - 👉 *While I **was studying**, my brother **was playing** outside.*
- **Time Marker: *while*** is commonly used for simultaneous actions.

◆ Understanding Clauses

- An **Independent Clause Can stand alone**; it is a **complete sentence** with a subject and verb.
 - 👉 *"I was watching TV."*
- A **Dependent Clause cannot stand alone** and needs an independent clause to complete its meaning.
 - 👉 *"When the power went out."*
- **Clause Order Rules:**
 - The order of clauses does not change the meaning.
 - If the dependent clause comes first, use a comma.

- **Examples:**

- “I was watching TV when the power went out.”
“When the power went [↑]out, I was watching TV.”
- “While he was walking, it started raining.”
“It started raining [↑]while he was walking.”

✓ **Ref Video**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RIEF3-onNWU>
